

Haithem HAMED

Systems & Virtualization Consultant - VMware, Veeam, Storage & Disaster Recovery

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PROFILE

Systems and virtualization engineer, 9 years in business-critical production, specialising in VMware, backup and business continuity. One constant throughout: migrating infrastructure without taking the service down - 500 virtual machines moved to vSphere 8.0 with 15 minutes of downtime, 30 sites switched from SSL VPN to MPLS with no interruption, directories and databases modernised, business applications moved to the cloud. Then industrialising what has been migrated: Ansible automation, monitoring, and disaster recovery plans that have genuinely been proven - one of them validated by a real power outage across more than 100 applications. Experience across both private and public sectors, including one year heading an IT department serving 500 users and, since 2024, working on client assignment for a public-sector organisation.

SKILLS

Virtualization	VMware vSphere 6.7 / 8.0, vCenter, HA, DRS, FT, vMotion, HPE SimpliVity, vRealize Operations, Proxmox, Hyper-V
Storage & continuity	Veeam Backup & Replication, Cohesity, HP 3PAR, EMC, SAN/NAS iSCSI, Disaster Recovery (DRP), Business Continuity (BCP), RTO/RPO
Automation	Ansible, GitLab, PowerShell, Python, Bash, Rundeck
Containers & data	Docker, nginx (reverse proxy), PostgreSQL, SQL Server, LDAP/LDAPS, SSO, Git/GitLab
Systems	Windows Server, Active Directory, GPO, ADFS, FSMO, Microsoft LAPS, Linux administration
Network & security	FortiGate, MPLS, IPsec/SSL VPN, VLAN, DNS/DHCP, SOC alerts, IPS, antivirus
Monitoring	SolarWinds, Zabbix, Centreon, Grafana, Nagios, Prometheus
Cloud	OVHcloud, Microsoft Azure IaaS, Kubernetes
Process & ITSM	ITIL, ServiceNow, GLPI, iTop, incident, change and release management, technical documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

OPEN - France January 2024 - Present
Senior Systems Consultant - client assignment: Office Français de la Biodiversité (French Biodiversity Agency)

- Led, over 12 months, the consolidation of 4 vCenter instances (20 ESXi hosts, 500 VMs) into a single HPE SimpliVity infrastructure on vSphere 8.0: 15 target hosts, 10 in production and 5 dedicated to disaster recovery.
- Migrated all 500 VMs from vSphere 6.7 to vSphere 8.0 with 15 minutes of service downtime across all business applications.
- Designed the disaster recovery plan covering more than 100 applications, proven under real conditions during a site power outage.
- Migrated 100 TB of traditional file servers to Cohesity.
- Migrated 30 servers and the ASTRE, CADIC, OSEAN and PARAPHEUR business applications from on-premise VMware to OVHcloud.
- Industrialised operations with Ansible: 50 playbooks covering the configuration of 300 servers, version-controlled in GitLab.
- Operated 200 Veeam backup jobs at a 99% success rate, alongside infrastructure monitoring.
- Technical lead for 4 business applications serving more than 300 staff; structured the operations, incident, change and release processes.

Flagship project · Infrastructure Operations and Monitoring Portal

Personal initiative adopted by the client as an internal application. Requirements definition, functional and technical specification, architecture and production rollout carried out independently; code developed with the assistance of generative AI tools. Operated and maintained by me across separate test and production environments, used by the entire infrastructure team - 20 engineers managing 600 servers.

- 9 modules behind a single sign-on (SSO) layer on Active Directory: real-time multi-datacenter VM inventory, detection of end-of-life operating systems and orphaned datastores, tracked decommissioning, Veeam job monitoring, release calendar, directory auditing and server security-agent coverage.

- Isolated container architecture: one container, one PostgreSQL database and an independent release cycle per module, behind an nginx reverse proxy - any module can be updated without interrupting the others.
- Security baseline defined and enforced: LDAPS SSO, per-module authorisation checked server-side, secrets held in an encrypted vault, audit logging, HTTP hardening, secret scanning and dependency auditing before each release.

Assurance Maghreb

January 2023 - December 2023

IT Department Manager

- Managed a team of 3, accountable for the information system serving 500 users.
- Migrated the Active Directory domain from 2008 to 2019 for 500 user accounts, and SQL Server from 2014 to 2022.
- Administered the VMware cluster: HA, FT, DRS, vMotion.
- Deployed Microsoft LAPS, eliminating shared local administrator passwords across the estate.
- Wrote Ansible playbooks and PowerShell scripts for recurring administration tasks.
- Implemented Veeam backup and triaged SOC, IPS and antivirus alerts.

ZENGROU

October 2021 - December 2022

Systems and Network Engineer

- Redesigned the network architecture across 30 sites: moved every link from SSL VPN to a managed MPLS network, the ERP being centrally hosted. Migration completed with no service interruption.
- Migrated 10 servers to OVHcloud.
- Administered the Proxmox hypervisor and kept Linux systems in operational condition.
- Deployed Centreon monitoring and integrated Veeam Backup.
- Administered FortiGate firewalls: high-availability cluster, VLANs, IPsec and SSL VPN.
- Managed NAS and SAN storage, handled iTop tickets and technical documentation.

NEW ENGINEERING IT

March 2020 - September 2021

Linux Systems Engineer

- Built a Kubernetes cluster hosting Nginx, Apache, PhpMyAdmin and PostgreSQL web services.
- Deployed Grafana, Zabbix, Centreon and Nagios monitoring.
- Defined security, backup and disaster recovery policies for the Linux estate; administered users, permissions and file systems.

PROXIWEB

January 2018 - February 2020

Systems Engineer

- Virtualised Linux and Windows machines on Proxmox, configured iSCSI and domain controllers.
- Automated Active Directory account creation and GPO deployment.
- Ran Veeam Backup, Centreon monitoring and GLPI ticket handling; installed web and VoIP servers.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) - Microsoft	2024
Master's degree, Systems and Network Development - ISET Sfax	2018
Bachelor's degree, Information Technology - ISET Sfax	2016
LPIC-1 - Linux Professional Institute	2015
CCNA 1-2-3 - Cisco Networking Academy	2014

LANGUAGES

Arabic C2 (native) · French C1 · English B1 · German A1